

Priyanka Pimple

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Fayetteville, AR

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics

Expected May 2027

University of Arkansas, Fayetteville, Arkansas

Committee: Arya Gaduh (Chair), Kyle Butts, Michael Gechter

M.A. in Economics

2020

Central University of Tamil Nadu, Thiruvavur, Tamil Nadu, India

Bachelor of Commerce

2018

Osmania University, Hyderabad, Telangana, India

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics; Applied Microeconomics; Gender Economics; Labor Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Dams and Rural Labor Markets in India (Job Market Paper)

Does large-scale infrastructure reverse structural transformation in the places that host it? Combining India's national registry of large dams with a three-round census panel of the villages surrounding dam sites, I show that where dams are completed, the composition of local work shifts back toward agricultural wage labor while non-farm employment contracts, the opposite of the transition India recorded nationally over the same decades. Identification comes from timing rather than placement: villages near completed dams are compared with villages near sanctioned-but-unfinished dams, which share the same siting characteristics. I find that the shift is concentrated in tribal villages, that women bear the larger share of the non-farm contraction, and that effects are largest upstream of the dam, where irrigation benefits cannot reach, separating winners from losers within a dam's vicinity in a way district-level designs cannot. The results supply a labor-market mechanism for the well-known finding that dams raise poverty in their own districts.

Balancing Motherhood and Employment: Analyzing the Consequences of Extended Maternity Leave in India (Working Paper)

Studies the labor market effects of India's 2017 extension of paid maternity leave from 12 to 26 weeks. Using a difference-in-differences design on three rounds of National Family Health Survey data (2005–2021), I find the policy reduced labor force participation among prime-childbearing-age women (20–34) by 2.6 percentage points, with the largest declines among the youngest (20–24) and most educated women, evidence consistent with employer reluctance to hire women of childbearing age as compliance costs rose. Results are robust to placebo and parallel-trends tests.

What Binds Women's Decision-Making? (Working Paper)

Sole-authored structured evidence review synthesizing 89 studies of gender-transformative approaches. Finds that household say, collective voice, and public participation follow distinct production functions, contrary to the conventional cascade theory of change.

PUBLICATION

Pimple, P., & Sumalatha, B. S. (2021). Out-of-pocket Health Spending and Its Impact on Household Well-being in Maharashtra. *Journal of Health Management*. [doi:10.1177/09720634211052412](https://doi.org/10.1177/09720634211052412)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern June-August 2026

Asian Development Bank (ADB), Manila, Philippines

Economic Research and Development Impact Department (ERDI)

Project: Systematic Review on Gender Transformative Interventions

- Conducted a systematic review of gender-transformative interventions in developing countries, comparing approaches by target population and level of change.
- Participated in EREA's Sustainable Development Goal 5 (Gender Equality) workshop.

Research Associate August 2021-January 2022

Mahindra University

- Managed large-scale datasets and conducted econometric analysis for policy-focused research projects.
- Produced analytical reports and presentations for multidisciplinary teams.

Research Associate May-August 2019

Centre for Economic and Social Studies (CESS), Hyderabad

- Conducted a policy evaluation of the Aarogyasri Health Insurance Scheme.
- Designed the evaluation methodology, collected field data, performed statistical analysis, and authored the final report for government stakeholders.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Arkansas

Basic Economics: Fall 2023; Spring 2024

Principles of Macroeconomics: Fall 2024; Spring 2025; Fall 2025; Spring 2026; Fall 2026; Spring 2027

SEMINARS AND PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Houston (scheduled) November 2026
"Dams and Rural Labor Markets in India"

Asian Development Bank, Economics Brownbag Seminar Series, Manila August 2026
"What Binds Women's Decision-Making?"

Midwest Economics Association (MEA) Annual Meeting, Chicago March 2026
"Dams and Rural Labor Markets in India"

HONORS AND AWARDS

Dr. Yien-I Tu Endowed Scholarship 2026-2027
Sam M. Walton College of Business

Adam Smith Fellowship 2025-2026
Mercatus Center, George Mason University

Carl Menger Fellowship
Mercatus Center, George Mason University

2024-2025

Doctoral Academy Fellowship
University of Arkansas

2022-2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: Stata (advanced), Python, QGIS

REFERENCES

Arya Gaduh

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ConocoPhillips Chair in International Economics & Business
Sam Walton College of Business, University of Arkansas
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